

# Hymn of Breaking Strain

*He went over it in his head, plate by plate, span by span, brick by brick, pier by pier,  
remembering, comparing, estimating, and recalculating, lest there should be any mistake;  
and through the long hours and through the flights of formulae that danced  
and wheeled before him, a cold fear would come to pinch his heart...*

Text: Rudyard Kipling, 1935, alt.

Music: Leslie Fish, 1983

BREAKING STRAIN 76.76.76.76.6

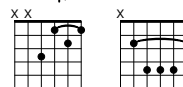
arr. Kenan Schaefkofer, 2021

D#m



C#

B



1 The care - ful text-books mea - sure  
2 But in our dai - ly deal - ing  
3 The pru - dent text-books give it  
4 We on - ly of Cre - a - tion  
5 Oh, veil - ed, se - cret Pow - er,

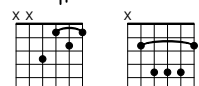
(Let all who build be - ware!)  
with stone and steel, we find  
in ta - bles at the end:  
(Oh, luck - ier bridge and rail)  
whose paths we seek in vain,

D#m



C#

B



1 the load, the shock, the pres - sure  
2 the gods have no such feel - ing  
3 the stress that shears a riv - et,  
4 a - bid the twin dam - na - tion:  
5 be with us in our hour—

ma - ter - i - al can bear.  
of guilt for hu - man - kind.  
or makes a tie - bar bend,  
To fail and know we fail.  
of ov - er-throw and pain;

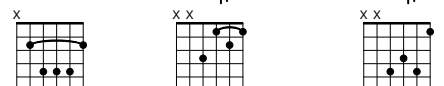
D#m



B

C#

D#m



1 So when a buck - led gir - der  
2 To no set gauge they make us,  
3 what traf - fic wrecks mac - a - dam,  
4 Yet we— by which sole to - ken  
5 that we— by which sure to - ken

lets down a steel cas - cade,  
for no laid course pre - pare,  
what con - crete should en - dure.  
we know we once were gods—  
we know Thy ways are true—

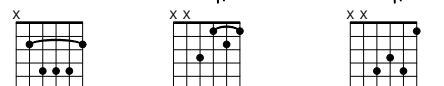
D#m



B

C#

D#m



1 the blame for loss, or mur - der  
2 and pres - ent - ly o'er - take us  
3 But we, of Eve and A - dam  
4 take shame in be - ing bro - ken,  
5 be - cause of be - ing bro - ken,

is on the ma - ker laid.  
with loads we can - not bear:  
have no such lit' - ra - ture,  
how - ev - er great the odds.  
may rise and build a - new.

Oh\_\_\_\_\_ the ma - ker, not the made!  
too mer - ci - less to bear.  
to warn us or make sure!  
Oh\_\_\_\_\_ the bur - den of the Odds.  
stand up and build a - new.